



NEWSLETTER

SHIFT Program Official Publication

JAN - MAR 2025

GASERA Awards and Banquet 2025: Honoring Service and Excellence

The Gawad sa Serbisyo at Epektibong Rekognisyon sa Ahensya (GASERA) Awards and Banquet 2025, held on January 28, 2025, was a night of celebration, recognition, and inspiration. The event brought together the TRC-LU family, partner organizations, and external stakeholders in a gathering that highlighted the spirit of service and excellence.

Distinguished guests ASEC. Ma. Belen V. Matibag of the Dangerous Drugs Board and Dir. Hedy Jose Lardizabal of the Civil Service Commission delivered powerful messages that underscored the importance of commitment, collaboration, and leadership in advancing the mission of public service. Their words set the tone for an evening dedicated to honoring those who have made remarkable contributions to TRC-LU and the broader community.

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Coming Soon: North Luzon's First Confirmatory Drug Testing Lab

The Treatment and Rehabilitation Center – La Union (TRC-LU) will soon open North Luzon's first confirmatory drug testing laboratory, funded by the Dangerous Drugs Board (DDB) and set for contract award in March 2025. This facility will provide accurate and reliable drug test confirmations, strengthening the government's anti-drug efforts and enhancing TRC-LU's services.

Alongside this project, TRC-LU is pursuing the Phase II expansion of its main building, which will house new services such as medical detoxification, nutrition and therapeutic clinics, smoking cessation, and social hygiene. An extension of the dormitory building is also being proposed to improve client facilities.

"These projects will ensure safety and quality care for staff and clients," said Dr. Marvin F. Munar, Chief of Hospital III. TRC-LU continues to expand its services to better serve its clients and the community.

At the heart of the celebration were the awardees, individuals and groups who have gone above and beyond in supporting the Center's mission of providing quality rehabilitation and care. From the leadership of our Chief of Hospital III, Dr. Marvin F. Munar, to the tireless efforts of our dedicated professionals, and the unwavering generosity of external stakeholders, each recipient of a GASERA Award embodied the essence of TRC-LU's seven core domains: Revenue, Resilience, Culture of the Organization, Research, Training, Technology, and Collaborative Healthcare.

The evening was more than just an awards ceremony it was a reaffirmation of TRC-LU's commitment to creating meaningful change. The achievements celebrated during the GASERA Awards serve as a beacon of hope, reminding us that through unity and shared purpose, we can transform lives and build a stronger, healthier community.



TRC-LU Launches Hilot Wellness Program and Confers NC II Scholars



For the first quarter of 2025, the Treatment and Rehabilitation Center – La Union (TRC-LU) began 2025 with the official launch of the Hilot Wellness Program, an initiative aimed at strengthening community support for clients and patients. The program was initiated by Mr. Ramon Torres, TRC-LU Multi-Sector Governance Council (MSGC) Member, in collaboration with the Office of the 1st District of La Union Representative, Congressman Francisco Paolo P. Ortega V, in partnership with the Technical Education and Skills Development Authority (TESDA) and the Asher Training and Assessment Center, Inc. (ASHER).

The program is designed to equip identified support groups of TRC-LU clients and patients with the competencies required to perform Hilot Wellness Massage in accordance with industry standards. As part of this initiative, 17 recipients of the Scholarship Grant of Hon. Congressman Ortega completed the NC II – Hilot and Wellness Massage course under TESDA's Training for Work Scholarship Program (TWSP). ASHER Training and Assessment Center, Inc., an accredited Technical Vocational Institution (TVI), facilitated both the skills and theoretical components of the course.

The Graduation and Conferment Ceremony was attended by Dr. Ramon Torres, Chief of Staff of Congressman Ortega and MSGC Member, who served as Guest of Honor and Speaker. Also present were Mrs. Dolores Camacho, ASHER Administrator; Ms. Thelma Tanganim, TESDA Assessor; and Dr. Marvin F. Munar, TRC-LU Chief of Hospital III.

TRC-LU and ASHER also formalized their partnership to continue providing skills training for patients and families, creating livelihood opportunities and supporting long-term recovery.



TRC-LU Seals Partnership with Lorma Colleges and DMMMSU for Psychology OJT Program



The Treatment and Rehabilitation Center – La Union (TRC-LU) has opened a new chapter in its advocacy for education and capacity-building through a formal collaboration with psychology students from Lorma Colleges, DMMMSU-MLUC, and DMMMSU-SLUC for On-the-Job Training (OJT) opportunities.

The Memorandum of Agreement (MOA) was officially signed on February 24, 2025, led by Dr. Marvin F. Munar, TRC-LU Chief of Hospital III, together with the deans/program chairs of the respective schools alongside the psychology students who will soon begin their internship journey.

This partnership will provide students with hands-on training in counseling, psychological assessment, and other essential skills within both clinical and forensic settings. It also underscores TRC-LU's commitment to fostering meaningful collaborations that not only enhance academic learning but also contribute to the professional growth of future psychologists.

With this initiative, TRC-LU reaffirms its role as a center of healing and learning, bridging education and service to strengthen the next generation of mental health professionals.



TRC-LU PARTNERS WITH SJRRHASS FOR DRUG-FREE WORKPLACES

The Treatment and Rehabilitation Center – La Union (TRC-LU) has signed a Memorandum of Agreement (MOA) with the San Juan Resort, Restaurant and Hotel Association (SJRRHASS) to promote drug-free workplaces and safer tourist destinations in San Juan, La Union.

Through this partnership, 96 privately owned hotels and restaurants with over 2,400 employees committed to support the advocacy campaign. The signing was attended by the TRC-LU family together with SJRRHASS President Ms. Monalisa Luebben-Binlot and EVP Rosalie Aquino.

This initiative highlights the vital role of NGOs and private stakeholders in fostering healthy, safe, and sustainable community settings.

CLOSING NOTES

As TRC-LU continues its journey of service, innovation, and collaboration, we extend our gratitude to our dedicated staff, supportive partners, and the community we serve. Each story in this issue reflects our shared commitment to healing, resilience, and transformation.

Together, let us move forward with renewed purpose, building healthier lives, stronger communities, and a brighter future for all.



OUR VISION

A prime TRC in Northern Luzon providing collaborative healthcare for substance dependents and the vulnerables by 2029